

April 2. 1907.

Vale.

- ① I reached Vale at dusk on the 31st ultimo, after a day's ride from Harbury. The road, if road it may be called, keeps the river on the ~~right~~^{left} hand nearly all the way, and the willows are just beginning to show a ~~dead~~^{pale} green. You would laugh to see the bridge they have here — two planks and a hand-rail, with the water ~~and~~^{very} close below. I was told last year the county had ~~voted~~^{at last} the money for a new one, but I see no sign of it yet.

Perhaps too
minute —
omit?

{ The people seem much as I remember them — ^{though} ~~hard~~
a little more reserved with strangers. [The store ^{is} ~~is~~
now in Mr. Ellison's hands, and] business ^{is} ~~is~~ slower,
~~he~~ complains, owing to the freight rates. noted.

- ③ I called on old Zadock Vale (no relation) — He remembers you well, ^{and} ~~and~~ sends his respects. He says the springs ran higher in your day. I fancy he is right. There is talk of ~~summer~~^{another} drought, if this rain holds off. Mrs. H — asks after you. [I did not see the schoolhouse. It was after hours.]
- ③a

- ④ Shall remain over Sunday. If the weather permits I ^{hope} ~~hope~~ to walk up into Flint Hollow ~~tomorrow~~^{tomorrow} and see how the new road ^{is} ~~is~~ getting on. They say it will help the miners.

Encl.

(Map sketch)

Yours truly

E. M. Linden.